

Harsha Asapu

[Portfolio-website](#) · [LinkedIn](#) · harshaasapu.b@gmail.com · OPT Authorized

SUMMARY

Design doesn't ship perfect. It ships clear, gets used, reveals what's wrong, and improves. That loop - identify, solve, ship, iterate is how I think about every product problem I work on.

My background moves from a client-facing startup where I owned 10+ products end-to-end, through graduate-level systems design, to active UX practice at a nonprofit. I research to find where the experience actually breaks, not where it looks broken then design the fix, build it, and keep going.

Open to Product Designer and UI/UX Designer roles.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UI/UX Designer | Community Dreams Foundation

Feb 2026 - Present

- Contribute to DreamStream UX by proposing design approaches, creating low-fidelity and high-fidelity wireframes, and iterating based on team feedback in Figma and FigJam.
- Collaborate asynchronously with PMs and developers via Slack and structured meetings to align design decisions with product and community goals.
- Apply usability and interaction principles developed across self-initiated case studies including behavioral system design (LifeOS) and state-visibility redesign (Starbucks) to real nonprofit product challenges.
- Exploring motion design and interaction prototyping as part of an ongoing practice that will extend into After Effects.

Product Designer & Frontend Engineer | BuiltinTech – IT Services

Jan 2023 - Dec 2023

- Designed and shipped 10+ client-facing web products owned the full experience from first conversation through production handoff and post-delivery iteration.
- Translated vague client needs into structured requirements, user flows, and responsive UI. Then went back and refined based on real feedback, not assumptions.
- Drove approximately 80% of client acquisition through direct outreach, requirement scoping, and trust-building. Learned that understanding the problem clearly is half the design work.
- Recruited and managed interns from KL University ran them through real project workflows, not simulated tasks.

Frontend Developer | Areksoft Technologies

Aug 2022 – Dec 2022

- First exposure to how production teams actually plan, review, and ship built responsive web interfaces in a structured enterprise environment.
 - Learned early that understanding how frontend and backend connect changes how you design Python and Flask exposure made feasibility a design instinct, not an afterthought.
 - Supported digital presence work through Figma, Canva, social media targeting, and campaign assets. First real look at how design serves business goals directly.
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PROJECTS

Starbucks Mobile Order Redesign

April 2026

2 weeks Figma | Smart Animate | FigJam | [Starbucks Redesign \(View it here\)](#)

- Identified the real break: not slow wait times, but zero visibility into when the barista actually starts the drink. A moment that didn't exist in the product
- Rejected three directions - GPS-triggered pickup, Domino's-style queue counter, live barista cam. Before arriving at a four-state model tied to actual barista actions
- Validated independently by Brian Niccol's Oct 2024 earnings call that he named mobile order pickup a turnaround priority and cited inaccurate wait times as a core problem
- One reusable state card, soft non-punishing language, amber not red restraint as a design decision

LifeOS - Behavioral Productivity System

March 2026

Figma | Behavioral Design | UX Research | [LifeOS UX Case study \(View it here\)](#)

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SLU Alumni Connect - Role-Based Engagement Platform

Dec 2025

Next.js | React | TypeScript | PostgreSQL | Prisma | [SLU Alumni Connect Live \(View it here\)](#)

- Identified the real break: alumni data existed across disconnected spreadsheets. Students couldn't find mentors, admins couldn't measure anything, alumni had no way to contribute
- Core design decision: role-aware UI students, alumni, mentors, and admins each see only what's relevant, eliminating cognitive overload across four distinct user types in one platform
- Led UI/UX design and frontend engineering unified 12,000+ alumni records, 262 events, and 811 mentorship relationships into a single production system
- Built on synthetic data from day one FERPA-compliant by design, not retrofitted

This Portfolio - Three Phase Product Build

2024 - Present

Next.js | Framer Motion | OpenAI RAG | TypeScript | [my_portfolio](#)

- Identified the real break across three iterations. Phase 1 said nothing, Phase 2 worked on desktop and broke on mobile, Phase 3 rebuilt every component from first principles at 375px
- Custom RAG chatbot trained on 8 markdown knowledge files answers questions about real work, grounded in actual content, not a gimmick
- Draggable corner-snapping chat widget solved a real UX problem (FAB covering content) while demonstrating interaction design capability in one feature
- The portfolio is the case study every design decision documented, every rejected idea named

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design - Figma (Auto Layout, Components, Prototyping, Responsive), Design Systems, Wireframing, Interaction Design, UX Research, Usability Testing, Information Architecture, Journey Mapping, FigJam, Low & High Fidelity Prototyping

Build - React · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Framer Motion · HTML/CSS · Git/GitHub

Process - Agile · Jira · Behavioral Design · MoSCoW Prioritization · Usability Testing · Iterative Design

Data & AI - OpenAI API · RAG Systems · Power BI · DAX · Python · Prompt Design

Learning - Google UX Design Certificate (Coursera · in progress) · A/B Testing (Udacity · in progress)

EDUCATION

MS in Information Systems, Saint Louis University, Saint Louis, Missouri

Jan 2024 - Dec 2025

Bachelors in Computer Science, Hyderabad, Telangana, India

May 2019 - June 2023